



upcoming five-match series in Australia in its bid to reach a third consecutive WTC final.

The Kiwi debacle, though, will perhaps inspire a refreshing context for the challenge ahead. For decades, Indian batters would head into a Test series in Australia under a cloud of apprehension, drowning in the potential uneasiness of handling the pacy, bouncy pitches Down Under. But, for a change, they

will perhaps look at the Border-Gavaskar series as a pleasant departure from the confines of home, which has turned from a fortress of steel to a coffin of suffocation.

Of late, Indian batters have sought to break free from their well-documented struggles against spin bowling with an attacking approach in the face of a dwindling trust in their ability and skill to

Stuck in a rut: Rohit Sharma faced a total of 133 balls across six innings, tallying a mere 91 runs, while middle-order mainstay Virat Kohli eked out 93 runs in six innings, facing 173 deliveries. AFP